

alised, we require enabling the potential of the network and building a supporting infrastructure,” says Thaploo of Apollo TeleHealth.

“Going forward, hospitals will be the base for acute care and with technology, healthcare will move into people’s homes to provide guidance on their basic medications and wellness,” says Dr Bishnu Panigrahi, Group Head of Medical Strategy and Operations at Fortis Healthcare.

Public health experts believe that India’s healthcare system must strike a balance between offering top-notch treatment in upscale urban hospitals and making sure that the vast rural masses have access to suitable medical facilities. Besides, what will also help will be the easy availability of and access to medical devices at reasonable rates. For that to happen, these need to be made in India. The government has already taken the first step by coming out with a production-linked incentive scheme for manufacturers of medical devices.

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MEANWHILE, THE VIRTUAL or remote healthcare space will be key for India going forward. According to data analytics website Statista, the global market for virtual or remote healthcare is expected to be over \$450 billion by 2030. A significant factor that will help its growth will be the use of AI. By using AI-based algorithms, patients can connect with healthcare providers or doctors with desired experience and access customised solutions aptly suited to their present health conditions. Data and analytics will play a big role in the transformation of the industry. By enhancing the ability to quickly adapt data and analytic techniques, adaptive data analytics (ADA) is already at the forefront of new-age research in the sector.

Medical experts say that the screening procedure can be sped up and an earlier diagnosis can be made by merging AI with portable screening equipment. “AI and IoMT have become dominant forces in business because they provide more ways to connect and exchange data, as well as the operational benefits that come with them,” says Hari Subramanian, Founder & Director of LifeSigns, a healthtech start-up. “IoT in healthcare and remote patient monitoring are developing in tandem to revolutionise the core notion of patient care. Biosensors will be able to help you make better decisions and keep an eye on your health in the future,” he adds.

But there are challenges. Public health experts say that efforts must be made to ensure the privacy of data and the development of a favourable regulatory environ-



“Creating a tech-enabled resilient health ecosystem to effectively manage the ongoing pandemic and responding to any pandemic in the future is the need of the hour”

MANSUKH MANDAVIYA
UNION MINISTER FOR HEALTH
& FAMILY WELFARE, IN A TWEET
IN MAY 2022

“Usage of tech can transform healthcare. While India has done well in terms of Covid-19 vaccination, it has a huge potential in adoption of tech advancements”

DR ROWLAND ILLING
DIRECTOR & CHIEF MEDICAL
OFFICER, INTERNATIONAL PUBLIC
SECTOR HEALTH, AWS



ment and policies that prioritise patient care.

Plus, not all the digital elements are connected. According to a report by industry body CII, in India, technology in the healthcare space is used in silos. For a robust mechanism to develop, digital elements need to be connected for applications to run smoothly. “Unlike big hospitals, smaller hospitals and clinics are not able to afford digital systems as they are expensive. Hence, to enable the use of technology, the central government has developed the Health Management Information System where it is in conversation with technology providers to enable the smaller players to store their data in the cloud at a reasonable price,” says the report.

In the next few years, the healthcare space is also likely to be impacted by 5G, which has already been rolled out in some parts of the country. A PwC report says that one of the areas in which 5G shows tremendous promise is remote surgery. With ultra-low latency internet powered by